

mobile applications and connect to phones via Bluetooth. A special paper is needed for the printer to work. Any image on your smartphone can be printed within minutes.

One popular portable printer is HP Sprocket. It is available for ₹ 7999 onwards on Amazon. The printer uses proprietary ZINK paper, available for ₹ 539 for a 20-sheet pack. Interestingly, HP Sprocket uses a proprietary crystal technology to print the photos on paper, so ink is not required.

OTG pendrives

Called by many names, OTG (on-the-go) pendrives, hybrid pendrives, dual pendrives and so on, these devices connect directly to the smartphone through the charger port. These save



Sandisk's OTG pendrive

you the hassle of connecting your phone's internal memory or external SD card to the computer to transfer files. You can also use these to move the files from one phone to another. Operations are pretty quick and smooth.

OTG pendrives come in various price ranges, depending on memory capacity. Products from various popular brands are available across online and offline shopping platforms. To give you an idea, a 16GB Sandisk OTG pendrive starts at ₹ 500, while a 32GB one at ₹ 900.

Gamepads

Playing on a phone often hinders the full gaming experience and, at times, risks the well-being of the screen. As an alternative, videogame enthusiasts can opt for gamepads supported by smartphones. Android users can go for gamepads like Amkette Evo. It comes



Amkette Evo wired gamepad

in two iterations—the basic wired one that costs ₹ 999, and the wireless Amkette Evo Pro 2 that costs ₹ 2000.

For iPhone users, gamepads are relatively expensive. For example, GameSir G5 supports iOS (alongside other platforms like Windows) and costs about ₹ 4700.

Zoom lenses

Smartphone cameras are being constantly improved and upgraded. To add extra flavours to their photo-capacities, photography fanatics can get lenses dedicated for smartphones. These lenses multiply the zoom capacity of smartphones and help produce life-like picture quality. These also increase the zoom of the phone by up to 12 times. Locally-produced lenses come for as little as ₹ 100, while good-



A zoom-multiplier lens for smartphone

quality ones can cost above ₹ 1000. Some examples are Life Like Universal lenses, Vellora Universal lenses and Vibex. These are available on online stores including Flipkart, Amazon and Paytm Mall.

Pebble PowerShare-Z

At a glance, the outer cover makes PowerShare-Z look like a child's toy. But when you take off the caps on both sides, it fits into the charging ports of two phones simultaneously. Its functionality is to draw charge from one phone and transfer to the other, provided the phone from which the



Pebble PowerShare-Z



charge is being drawn is OTG-compatible. The device can provide charge to almost any smartphone including iPhone (an additional iPhone connector is provided in the box).

While some users have found the power transfer process to be slow, others have reported it to be sturdy and easy-to-use. Overall, this small gizmo can be a last-minute saviour by giving your phone a bit more life to make that emergency phone call before it runs out of battery completely. It is priced between ₹ 300 and ₹ 400, and is available on Amazon.

There are many more accessories that can be fun, innovative and useful. If you are aware of those that are not mentioned here, do let us know! **EFY**